

Nickolas Stricker

Sales Engineer | Solutions Engineer | Senior Full-Stack Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior Full-Stack Engineer and founder with 6+ years of experience closing the gap between technical complexity and business outcomes. Drove 24-43% conversion gains for clients by leading technical discovery, designing solution architectures, and communicating tradeoffs in plain language that moves deals forward. Built and deployed production AWS infrastructure, REST APIs, and multi-tenant SaaS platforms for real paying clients, including PCI-compliant payment systems handling sensitive financial data. Skilled at running pre-sales discovery, building POCs fast, and taking the technical load off AEs so deals close. Delivered in-person enterprise software demos at national trade shows. AWS Solutions Architect certified.

SKILLS

Technical Discovery and Pre-Sales: End-to-end discovery calls, requirements gathering, pain-to-solution mapping, POC development, live demos, objection handling, stakeholder communication

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS Solutions Architect certified, Lambda, EC2, S3, CloudFront, static IP / PCI compliance, IAM, CI/CD, infrastructure design and deployment

Data and APIs: SQL, relational data modeling, REST API design, OAuth 2.0 / API authentication, analytics pipelines, webhook implementation, third-party integrations (Clover, Square, Converge, ChatGPT)

Development: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, Java, C#, HTML/CSS, Tailwind

AI and Productivity: Claude Code and Codex daily with context-first prompting and full code review, 5x feature velocity; ChatGPT API integrated into production SaaS platform; agentic workflow design with LLM orchestration and tool use

EXPERIENCE

Stricker Digital | Chicago, IL | Founder / Sales Engineer and Full-Stack Developer Aug 2025 - Present

- Drove 24-43% conversion gains across client projects by leading discovery, designing tailored solutions, and iterating on UX and performance until outcomes were measurable.
- Led end-to-end technical discovery calls, assessed client current-state architecture, business goals, pain points, and budget constraints before proposing a single line of code.
- Designed and pitched solution architectures spanning frontend (React/Next.js), backend (Node.js/REST APIs), cloud infrastructure (AWS), and third-party integrations, communicated tradeoffs in plain language to non-technical stakeholders.
- Built a multi-tenant SaaS e-commerce platform on Next.js and AWS serving multiple live clients, including payment processor integrations (Clover, Square, Converge), PCI-compliant infrastructure design, OAuth 2.0 authentication flows, and AI admin tools.
- Designed and deployed PCI-compliant AWS infrastructure, including static IP configuration and payment processor authentication, ensuring sensitive financial data handling met compliance requirements under real client pressure.
- Ran full POC-to-retainer cycle for Redtiallux (luxury watch retailer): identified trust signal gaps and checkout friction during discovery, redesigned multi-step checkout flow, drove 30% conversion lift in month one.
- Explained complex technical concepts (SEO, API architecture, checkout UX, payment security) to non-technical clients using plain-language analogies that produced buy-in and action, not confusion.
- Set up GA4 analytics instrumentation on every engagement upfront to measure outcomes and demonstrate ROI.

Expocad by A.C.T | Aurora, IL | Senior Full-Stack Engineer (Acting Tech Lead) May 2021 - Present

- Delivered in-person enterprise software demonstrations at national trade shows annually, presenting live to show managers, exhibitors, and enterprise clients, walking audiences through booth rental workflows, interactive floor plans, and contract completion.
- Led technical discovery and solution design across frontend, backend, and data systems for enterprise tradeshow platform, translated business requirements into architecture decisions across a 600,000-line codebase.
- 30% application performance improvement: profiled and optimized SQL queries, API data flows, and UI on enterprise workflows.
- 22% reduction in user friction: mined support ticket trends and usage data to identify friction hotspots.
- Architected and shipped a real-time attendee dashboard from scratch, React frontend, REST APIs, Node.js backend, SQL data models, and live direct messaging via webhooks (Teams-style chat, file uploads, group channels). The feature is still live and growing.
- Led architecture and full-stack delivery of major product features; wrote tickets, designed data models, owned API contracts, and mentored junior engineers through 600K-line codebase onboarding.
- Acted as technical point of contact across product, engineering, and support teams, translated customer-reported friction into prioritized technical improvements aligned to business goals.
- Implemented AI-assisted development workflow for team (Claude Code + Codex with context-first prompting and line-by-line review).

Bloom Institute of Technology | Remote | Teaching Assistant 2020 - 2021

- Mentored 10+ students through an 18-month full-stack bootcamp, coached a struggling student to reconnect with his goals.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Amazon Web Services: [Certified Solutions Architect Associate](#)

CompTIA Security+: In Progress

Google: [Digital Marketing and E-Commerce Professional Certificate](#)

Bloom Institute of Technology: [Full Stack Web Developer + Computer Science Certificate](#)